Memo

To	Foundation board
From	Exhibition committee
Date	30 October 2026
Subject	Winter exhibition

Today the tower belongs to a foundation that opens it to the public in summer. The log books have been scanned, transcribed and indexed, and a small exhibition in the old oil store shows the lamp, the auger and a page from the winter of 1893.

The transcription project took four years and relied almost entirely on volunteers. Handwriting changed from keeper to keeper, abbreviations drifted, and the ink of the earliest volumes had faded to the colour of weak tea, so every page was read twice by different people.

Visitors were rare and were recorded with care: a priest in 1880, a painter who stayed for three weeks in 1911 and left a small oil sketch of the tower, and a group of surveyors whose instruments, the log notes drily, were less reliable than the keeper's barometer.

What emerges from the logs is not a story of heroism but of attention: a century of people who looked at the same stretch of sea every day and wrote down what they saw, so that others could find their way home in the dark.

DRAFT